RULES AND REGULATIONS FOR

“Salem Star Speaker”

CONTEST

1 General Eligibility

- Participants must fall into one of the following age categories as of **25 October 2026**:

  i) Juniors: Born between 1 November 2012 and 31 October 2016

  ii) Teens: Born between 1 November 2008 and 31 October 2012

  iii) Adults: Born on or before 31 October 2008
- Participants may register in one category only.
- Only one entry per participant is allowed.
- This contest is open only to **non-Toastmasters members**.
- Only residents of **Salem District** are eligible to participate.

2 Registration and Briefing

REGISTRATION CLOSES	ONLINE BRIEFING AND SPEAKING ORDER
26 October 2026 Monday at 23:59 hours	**30th October 2026** Friday, at 20:30 hours

- Registration closes on 26 October 2026, Monday at 23:59 hours.
- Prelims may be conducted online if registrations are higher.
- Only **finalists** will have to pay 250 as registration fee.
- Online contestants' briefing and speaking order will be conducted on 30th October 2026, Friday, at 20:30 hours.
- Absent contestants shall be represented by those present as proxies.
- The speaking order, once fixed, shall not be changed.

3 Speech Guidelines

- Speeches must be delivered in **English only**.
- Speeches must be substantially original.
- The speech should have a clear structure, including an introduction, body, and conclusion.
- No cue cards, prompts, or script reading will be allowed.
- The speech must begin immediately once the contestant is introduced by the Contest Master.
- Timing starts when the speaker displays body language (e.g., a smile), begins speaking, or after 3 seconds elapse, whichever occurs first.
- The decision of the judges shall be final and binding.

4 Contest Rules

Category	Age Group	Speech Time	Green Card	Yellow Card	Red Card
Juniors	10-13 Years	2 to 4 minutes	2:00	3:00	4:00
Teens	14-17 Years	3 to 5 minutes	3:00	4:00	5:00
Adults	18+ Years	5 to 7 minutes	5:00	6:00	7:00

5 Timing Signals

- **Green Card:** Minimum speech time reached.
- **Yellow Card:** One minute remaining.
- **Red Card:** Maximum speech time reached.

6 Additional Guidelines

- Participants are encouraged to conclude their speech before or at the Red Card.
- Speeches under or over the prescribed time limits may be subject to disqualification at the discretion of the organizers.
- Timekeeping decisions by the contest officials will be final.